JUSTICE BRENNAN delivered the opinion of the Court.

This case requires us to address a conflict between a State's efforts to eliminate gender-based discrimination against its citizens and the constitutional freedom of association asserted by members of a private organization. In the decision under review, the Court of Appeals for the Eighth Circuit concluded that, by requiring the United States Jaycees to admit women as full voting members, the Minnesota Human Rights Act violates the First and Fourteenth Amendment rights of the organization's members. We noted probable jurisdiction, *Gomez-Bethke* v. *United States Jaycees*, 464 U. S. 1037 (1984), and now reverse.

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The United States Jaycees (Jaycees), founded in 1920 as the Junior Chamber of Commerce, is a nonprofit membership corporation, incorporated in Missouri with national headquarters in Tulsa, Okla. The objective of the Jaycees, as set out in its bylaws, is to pursue

> "such educational and charitable purposes as will promote and foster the growth and development of young men's civic organizations in the United States, designed to inculcate in the individual membership of such organization a spirit of genuine Americanism and civic inter-

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Pinzler, *E. Richard Larson*, and *Charles S. Sims;* for Community Business Leaders by *Eldon J. Spencer, Jr.;* for the NAACP Legal Defense and Educational Fund, Inc., by *Jack Greenberg*, *Beth J. Lief*, and *Judith Reed;* for the National League of Cities et al. by *Lawrence R. Velvel* and *Elaine D. Kaplan;* for the National Organization for Women et al. by *Judith I. Avner* and *Charlotte M. Fischman;* and for Women's Issues Network, Inc., by *Neil H. Cogan.*

Briefs of *amici curiae* urging affirmance were filed for the Boy Scouts of America by *Philip A. Lacovara*, *Malcolm E. Wheeler*, *George A. Davidson*, and *David K. Park;* for the Conference of Private Organizations by *Leonard J. Henzke, Jr.;* and for Rotary International by *William P. Sutter* and *Wm. John Kennedy.*